

16

Sicilian Tactical Grammar

Exchange sacrifices, clearance breaks, and king races: the recurring combinations behind the theory.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will calculate thematic tactics from positional cues and know when the famous sacrifice is unsound.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 091 | PAGE 4

Decode: The Dragon exchange sacrifice on c3*A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.*

LESSON 092 | PAGE 8

Play: The Dragon exchange sacrifice on c3*A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.*

LESSON 093 | PAGE 12

Decode: The Najdorf ...d5 clearance*A clearance break is about the pieces released, not the pawn traded.*

LESSON 094 | PAGE 16

Play: The Najdorf ...d5 clearance*A clearance break is about the pieces released, not the pawn traded.*

LESSON 095 | PAGE 20

Decode: Pawn-storm contact points*Pawn storms are decided at contact, not by distance traveled.*

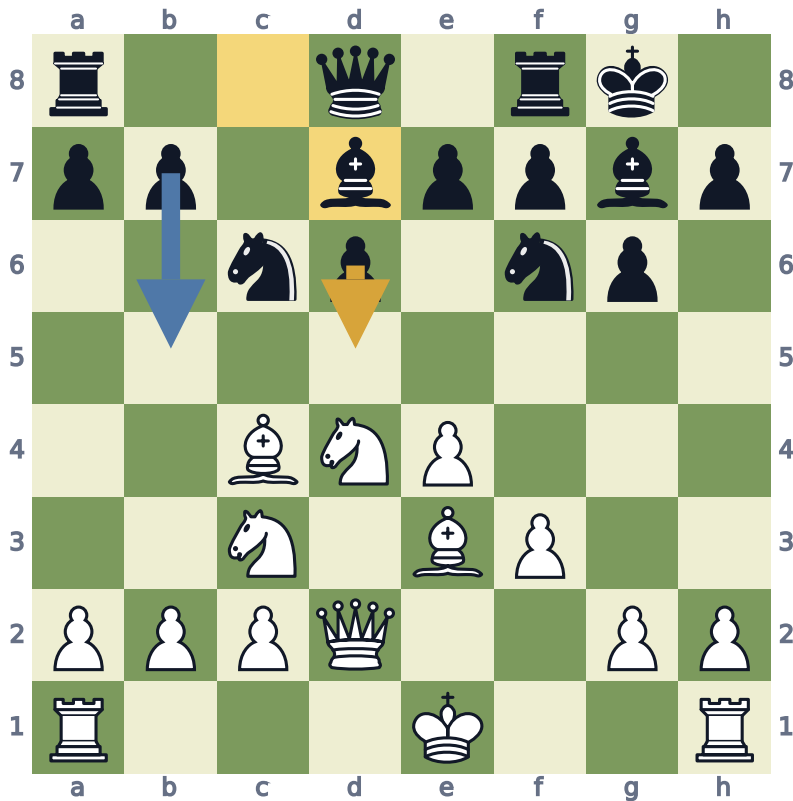
LESSON 096 | PAGE 24

Play: Pawn-storm contact points*Pawn storms are decided at contact, not by distance traveled.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will calculate thematic tactics from positional cues and know when the famous sacrifice is unsound.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The Dragon exchange sacrifice on c3



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Rxc3 motifs destroy the knight guarding e4 and the castled king, often trading exchange material for structure, dark squares, and attack.

DECISION RULE

After the exchange sacrifice, name the next two forcing moves and the exact compensation.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Calculate ...Rxc3 only when the follow-up reaches c2, the king, or e4 before White consolidates.

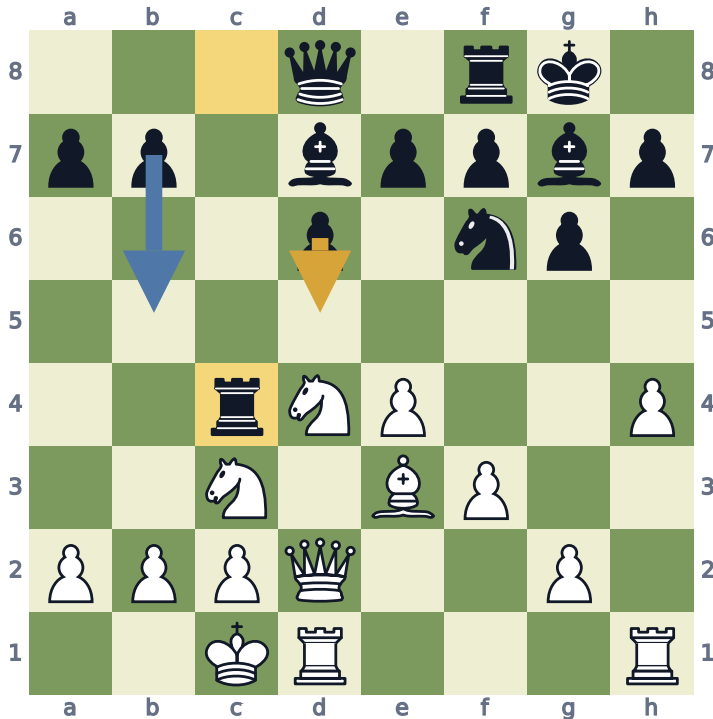
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White protects c3 tactically, trades attacking pieces, and returns material to reach safety.

MEMORY RULE | A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Rxc3 motifs destroy the knight guarding e4 and the castled king, often trading exchange material for structure, dark squares, and attack.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Calculate ...Rxc3 only when the follow-up reaches c2, the king, or e4 before White consolidates.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White protects c3 tactically, trades attacking pieces, and returns material to reach safety.

FAILURE MODE

Sacrificing because the pattern is famous when no queen entry or pawn destruction follows.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After the exchange sacrifice, name the next two forcing moves and the exact compensation. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

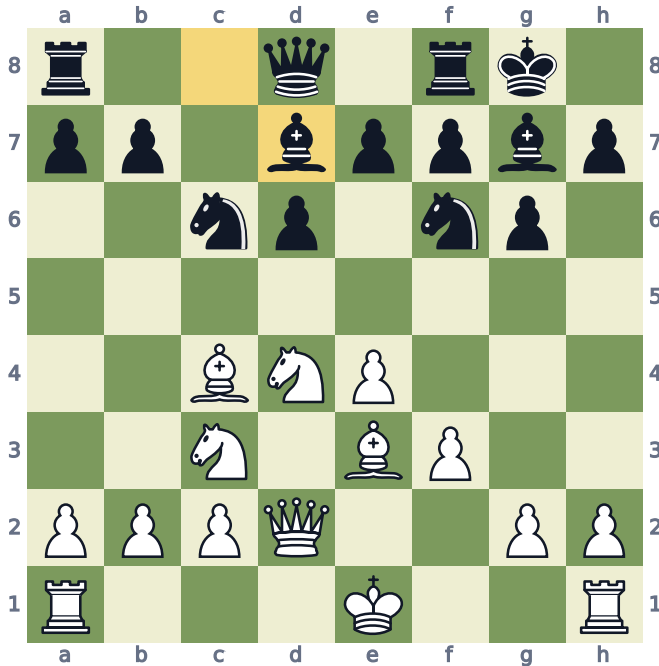
RULE | A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. Bc4 Bd7 10. O-O-O Rc8 11. Bb3 Ne5 12. h4 Nc4 13. Bxc4 Rxc4



- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Qd2: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bc4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bd7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Rxc3 motifs destroy the knight guarding e4 and the castled king, often trading exchange material for structure, dark squares, and attack.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After the exchange sacrifice, name the next two forcing moves and the exact compensation. White's resistance is: White protects c3 tactically, trades attacking pieces, and returns material to reach safety. The line fails as a template when: Sacrificing because the pattern is famous when no queen entry or pawn destruction follows.

STORE THIS | A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

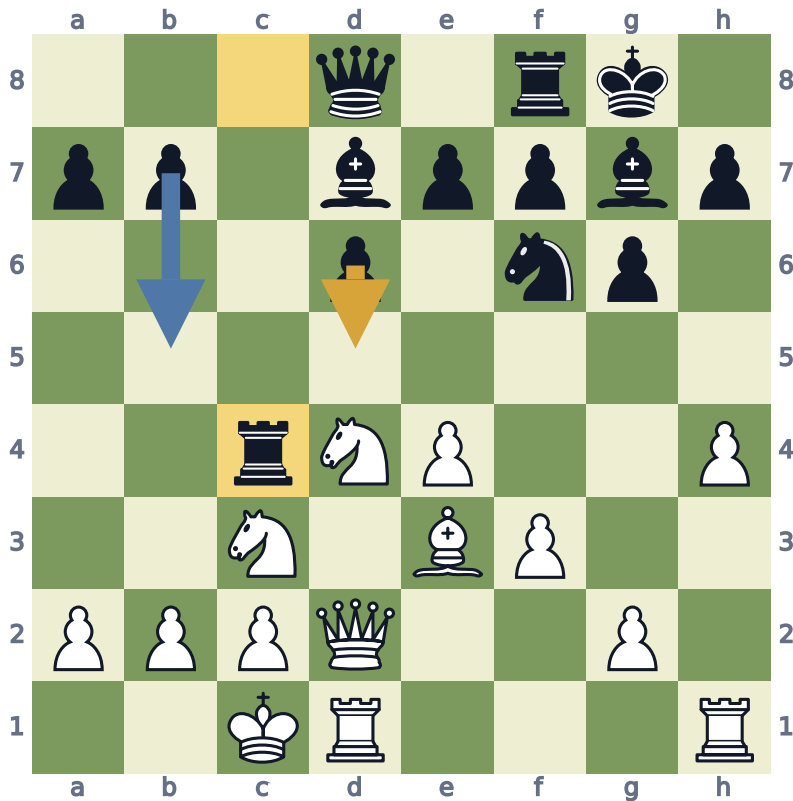
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. Bc4 Bd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The Dragon exchange sacrifice on c3



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Rxc3 motifs destroy the knight guarding e4 and the castled king, often trading exchange material for structure, dark squares, and attack.

DECISION RULE

After the exchange sacrifice, name the next two forcing moves and the exact compensation.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Calculate ...Rxc3 only when the follow-up reaches c2, the king, or e4 before White consolidates.

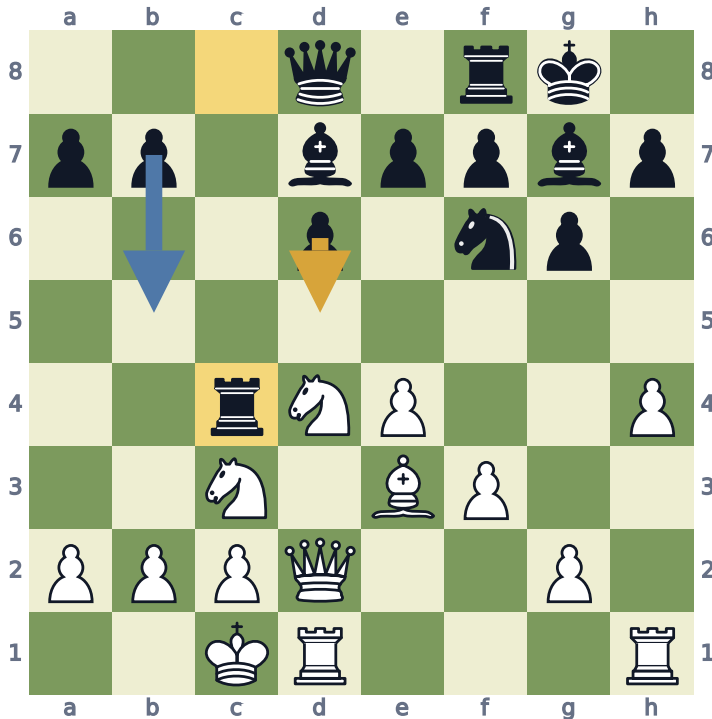
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White protects c3 tactically, trades attacking pieces, and returns material to reach safety.

MEMORY RULE | A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Rxc3 motifs destroy the knight guarding e4 and the castled king, often trading exchange material for structure, dark squares, and attack.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Calculate ...Rxc3 only when the follow-up reaches c2, the king, or e4 before White consolidates.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White protects c3 tactically, trades attacking pieces, and returns material to reach safety.

FAILURE MODE

Sacrificing because the pattern is famous when no queen entry or pawn destruction follows.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After the exchange sacrifice, name the next two forcing moves and the exact compensation. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

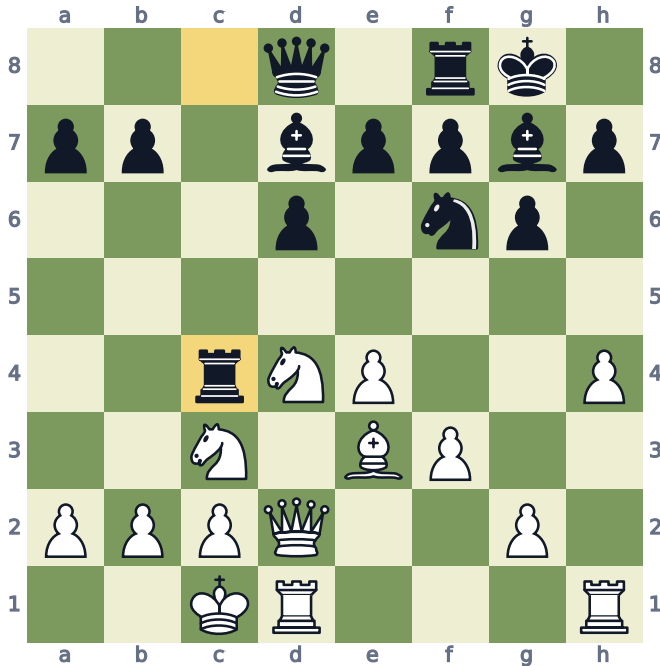
RULE | A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. Bc4 Bd7 10. O-O-O Rc8 11. Bb3 Ne5 12. h4 Nc4 13. Bxc4 Rxc4



- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Ne5: Black reroutes a knight to e5; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- h4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nc4: Black reroutes a knight to c4; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bxc4: White releases tension by capturing on c4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Rxc4: Black releases tension by capturing on c4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Rxc3 motifs destroy the knight guarding e4 and the castled king, often trading exchange material for structure, dark squares, and attack.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After the exchange sacrifice, name the next two forcing moves and the exact compensation. White's resistance is: White protects c3 tactically, trades attacking pieces, and returns material to reach safety. The line fails as a template when: Sacrificing because the pattern is famous when no queen entry or pawn destruction follows.

STORE THIS | A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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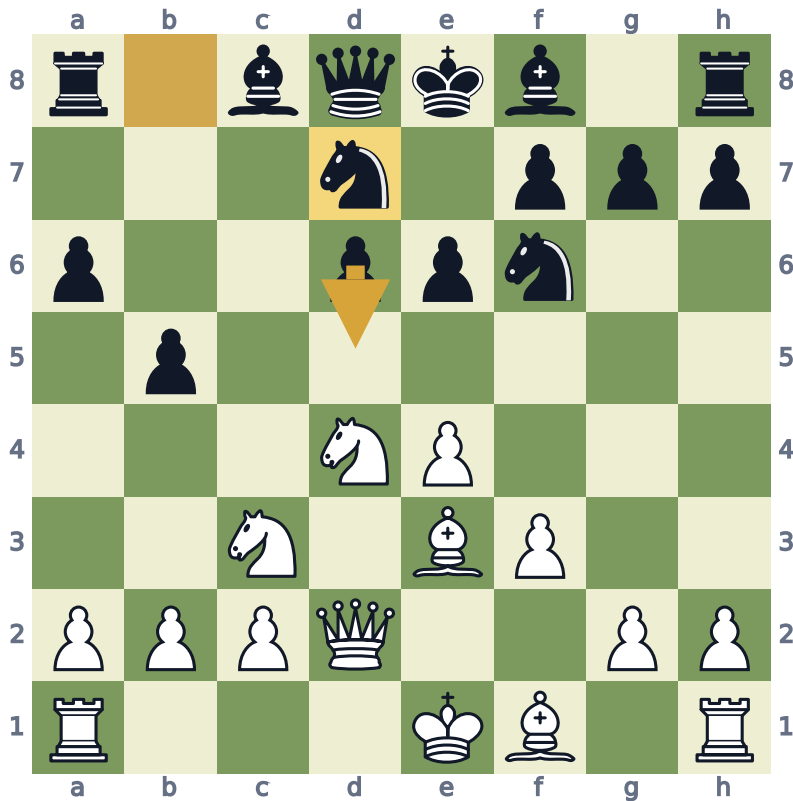
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 26 plies from memory, then replay: 11. Bb3 Ne5 12. h4 Nc4 13. Bxc4 Rxc4

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The Najdorf ...d5 clearance



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

A central ...d5 can clear diagonals, remove White's space, and turn queenside pressure into a direct attack.

DECISION RULE

What opens after ...d5: which rook, bishop, and queen lines appear for both sides?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Prepare the break with piece pressure and calculate every central capture, especially discovered attacks on the kings.

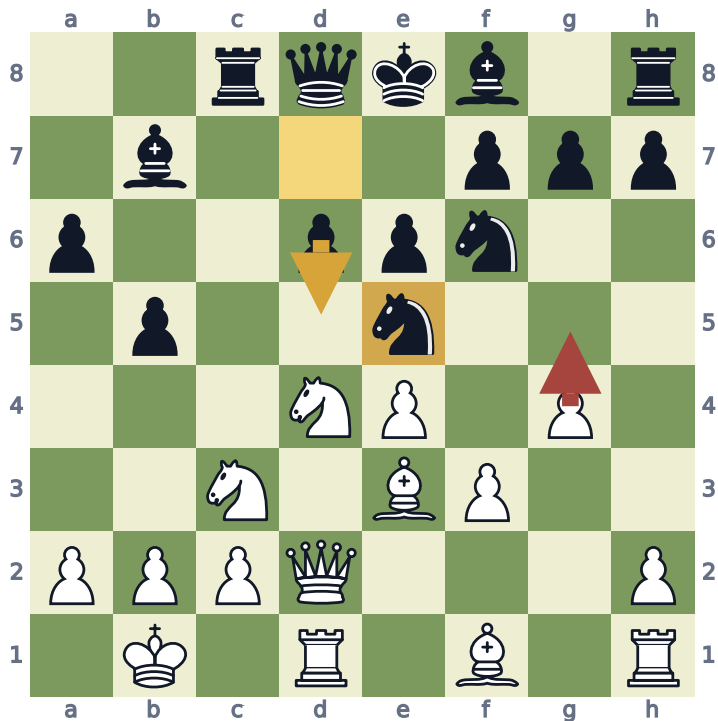
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White keeps d5 controlled and uses g5 or e5 to seize the initiative first.

MEMORY RULE | A clearance break is about the pieces released, not the pawn traded.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

A central ...d5 can clear diagonals, remove White's space, and turn queenside pressure into a direct attack.

BLACK AIMS FOR

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White keeps d5 controlled and uses g5 or e5 to seize the initiative first.

FAILURE MODE

Evaluating only the pawn exchange and overlooking the lines it uncovers.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What opens after ...d5: which rook, bishop, and queen lines appear for both sides? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

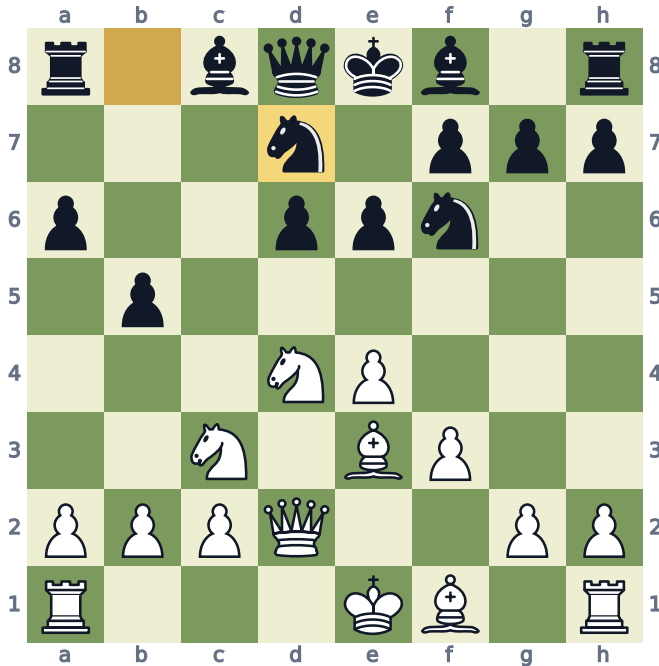
RULE | A clearance break is about the pieces released, not the pawn traded.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. Qd2 b5 8. f3 Nbd7 9. g4 Bb7 10. O-O-O Rc8 11. Kb1 Ne5



- Be3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Qd2: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- b5: Black starts queenside expansion and prepares files or a bishop diagonal.
- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

A central ...d5 can clear diagonals, remove White's space, and turn queenside pressure into a direct attack.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What opens after ...d5: which rook, bishop, and queen lines appear for both sides? White's resistance is: White keeps d5 controlled and uses g5 or e5 to seize the initiative first. The line fails as a template when: Evaluating only the pawn exchange and overlooking the lines it uncovers.

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1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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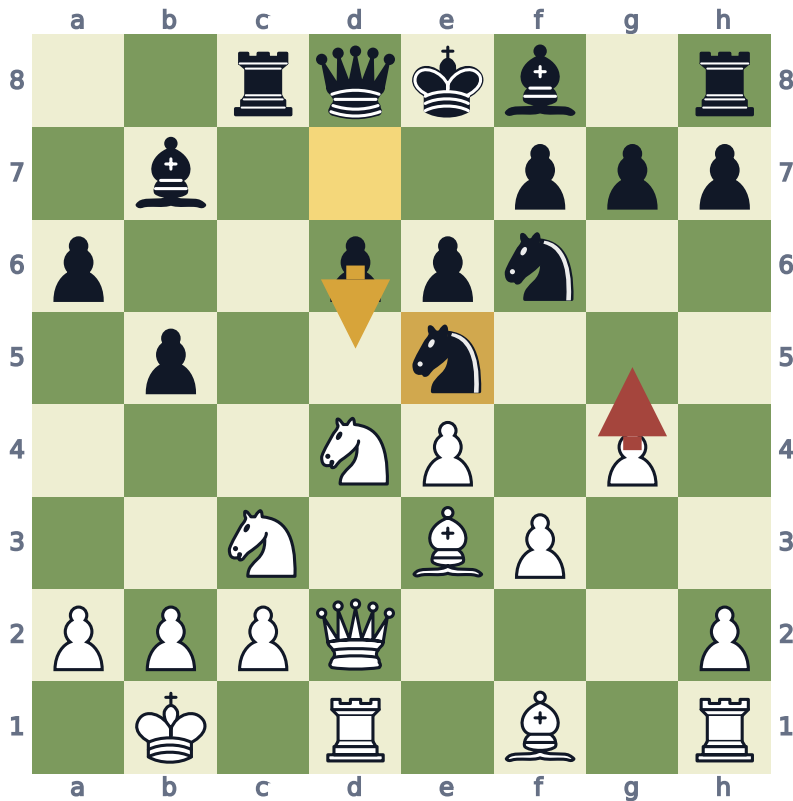
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Be3 e6 7. Qd2 b5 8. f3 Nbd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The Najdorf ...d5 clearance



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

A central ...d5 can clear diagonals, remove White's space, and turn queenside pressure into a direct attack.

DECISION RULE

What opens after ...d5: which rook, bishop, and queen lines appear for both sides?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Prepare the break with piece pressure and calculate every central capture, especially discovered attacks on the kings.

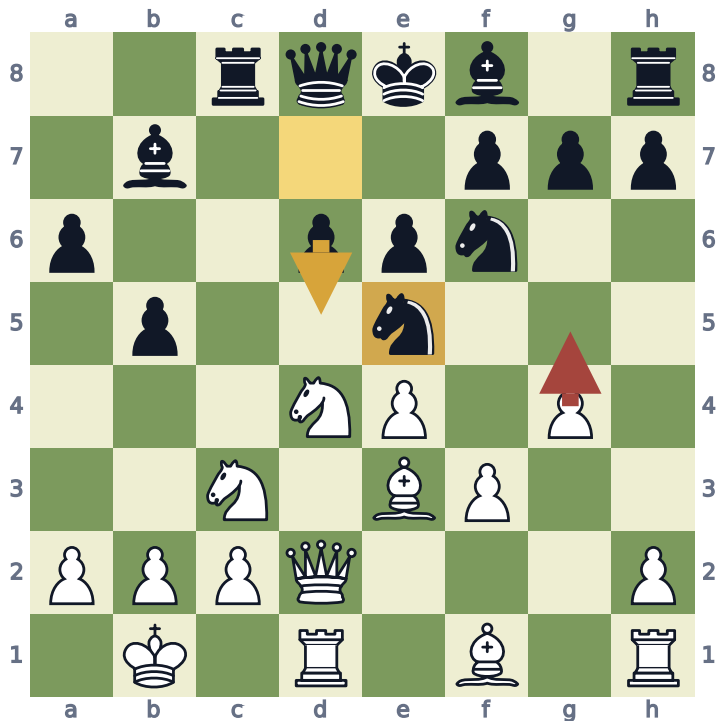
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

A central ...d5 can clear diagonals, remove White's space, and turn queenside pressure into a direct attack.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Prepare the break with piece pressure and calculate every central capture, especially discovered attacks on the kings.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White keeps d5 controlled and uses g5 or e5 to seize the initiative first.

FAILURE MODE

Evaluating only the pawn exchange and overlooking the lines it uncovers.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What opens after ...d5: which rook, bishop, and queen lines appear for both sides? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

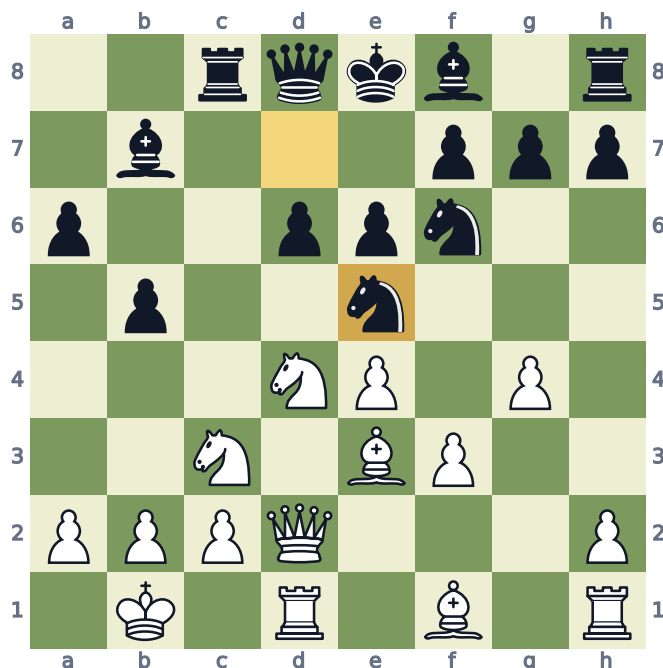
RULE | A clearance break is about the pieces released, not the pawn traded.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- g4: White starts a direct pawn storm and threatens to gain time on the f6 knight.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- O-O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Rc8: Black places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- Kb1: White improves coordination and changes the candidate set.
- Ne5: Black reroutes a knight to e5; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

A central ...d5 can clear diagonals, remove White's space, and turn queenside pressure into a direct attack.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What opens after ...d5: which rook, bishop, and queen lines appear for both sides? White's resistance is: White keeps d5 controlled and uses g5 or e5 to seize the initiative first. The line fails as a template when: Evaluating only the pawn exchange and overlooking the lines it uncovers.

STORE THIS | A clearance break is about the pieces released, not the pawn traded.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

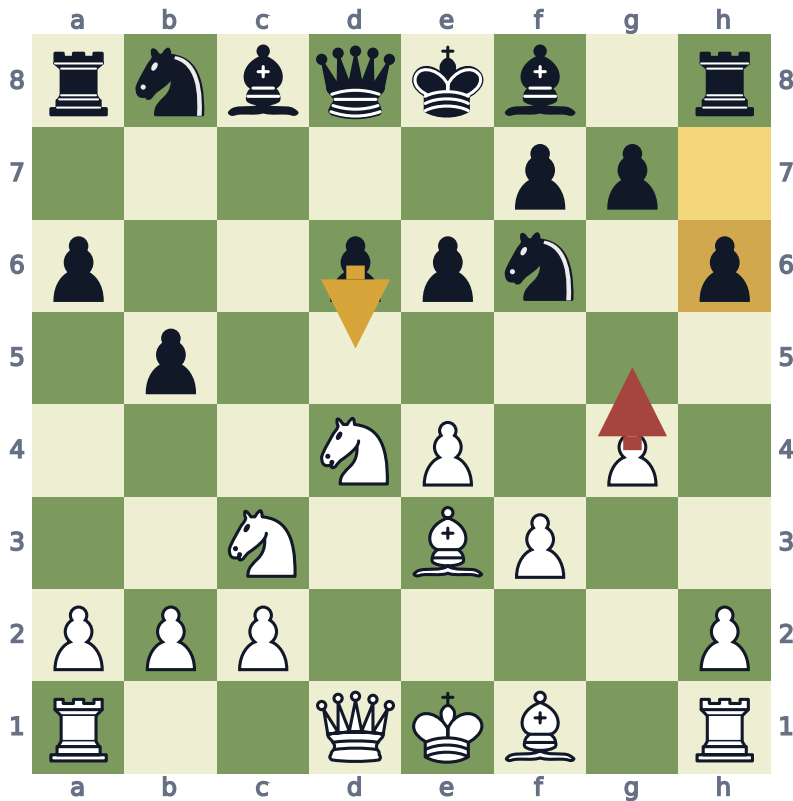
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. g4 Bb7 10. O-O-O Rc8 11. Kb1 Ne5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Pawn-storm contact points

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Opposite-side attacks become tactical when pawns make contact: g5, h5, ...b4, or ...d5 changes lines and tempos immediately.

DECISION RULE

Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Identify the first profitable contact, calculate forcing replies, and use defensive pawn moves only when they slow more than they weaken.

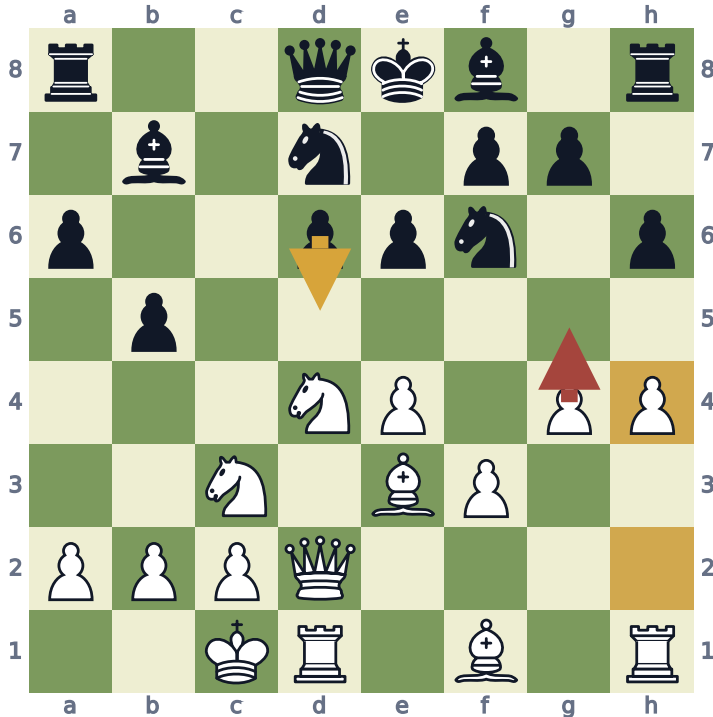
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White opens h- or g-files and uses sacrifices to remove the last pawn shield.

MEMORY RULE | Pawn storms are decided at contact, not by distance traveled.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Opposite-side attacks become tactical when pawns make contact: g5, h5, ...b4, or ...d5 changes lines and tempos immediately.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Identify the first profitable contact, calculate forcing replies, and use defensive pawn moves only when they slow more than they weaken.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White opens h- or g-files and uses sacrifices to remove the last pawn shield.

FAILURE MODE

Counting squares advanced rather than files opened and tempi gained.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

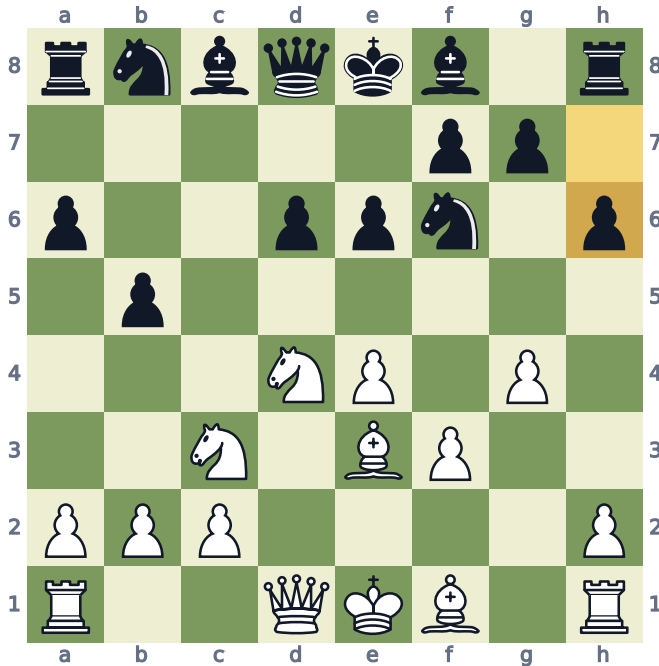
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- Be3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- b5: Black starts queenside expansion and prepares files or a bishop diagonal.
- g4: White starts a direct pawn storm and threatens to gain time on the f6 knight.
- h6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Opposite-side attacks become tactical when pawns make contact: g5, h5, ...b4, or ...d5 changes lines and tempos immediately.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king? White's resistance is: White opens h- or g-files and uses sacrifices to remove the last pawn shield. The line fails as a template when: Counting squares advanced rather than files opened and tempi gained.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

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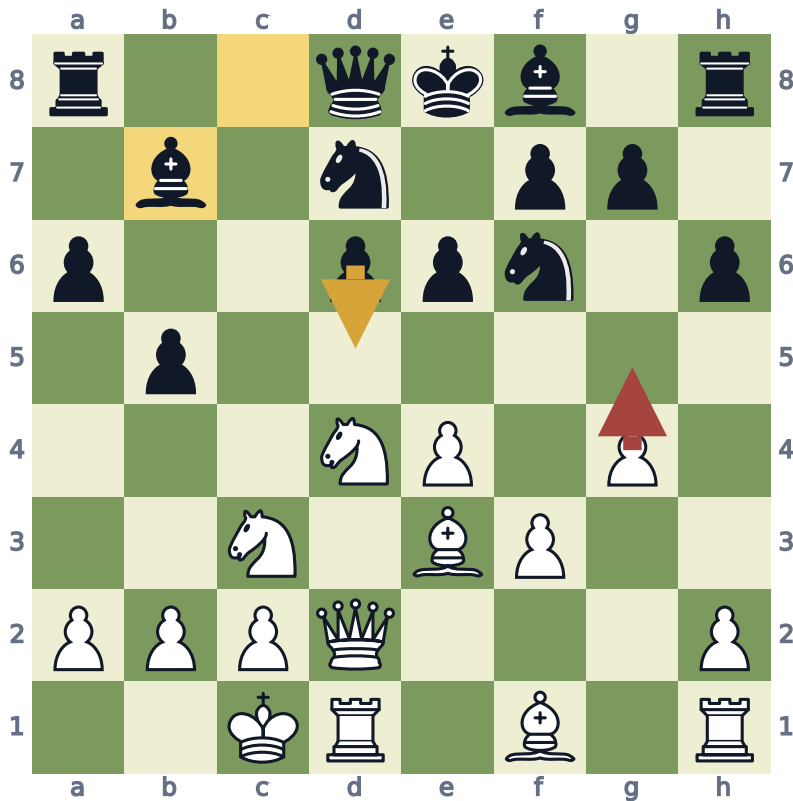
1. Opposite-side attacks become tactical when pawns make contact: g5, h5, ...b4, or ...d5 changes lines and tempos immediately. 2. Identify the first profitable contact, calculate forcing replies, and use defensive pawn moves only when they slow more than they weaken. 3. White opens h- or g-files and uses sacrifices to remove the last pawn shield. 4. Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king? 5. Counting squares advanced rather than files opened and tempi gained.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. g4 h6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Pawn-storm contact points



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Opposite-side attacks become tactical when pawns make contact: g5, h5, ...b4, or ...d5 changes lines and tempos immediately.

DECISION RULE

Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Identify the first profitable contact, calculate forcing replies, and use defensive pawn moves only when they slow more than they weaken.

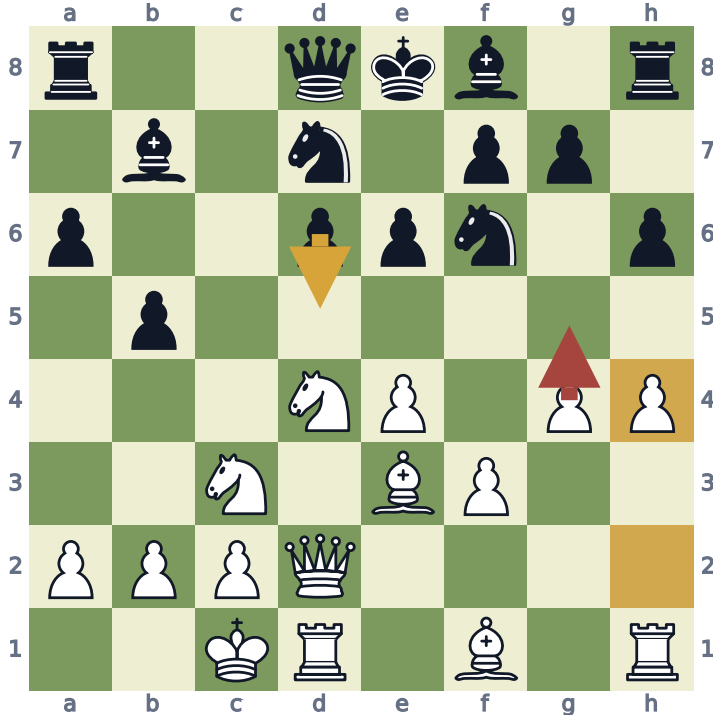
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MEMORY RULE | Pawn storms are decided at contact, not by distance traveled.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Opposite-side attacks become tactical when pawns make contact: g5, h5, ...b4, or ...d5 changes lines and tempos immediately.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Identify the first profitable contact, calculate forcing replies, and use defensive pawn moves only when they slow more than they weaken.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White opens h- or g-files and uses sacrifices to remove the last pawn shield.

FAILURE MODE

Counting squares advanced rather than files opened and tempi gained.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

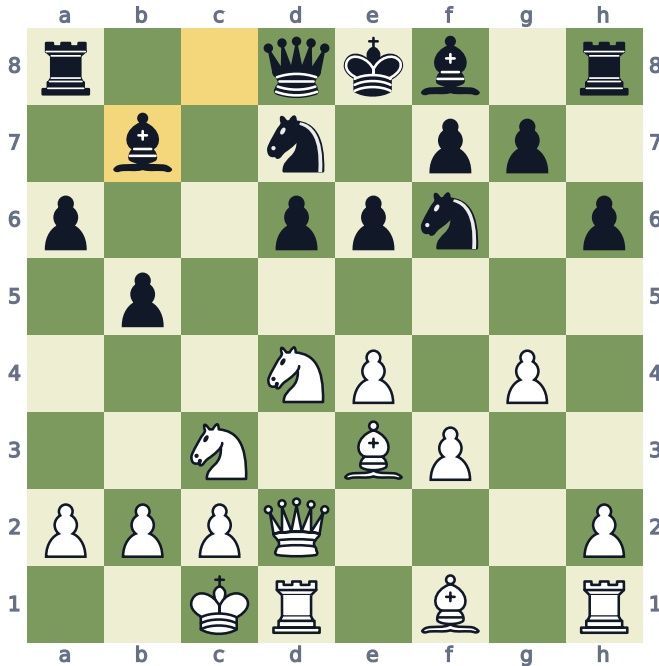
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. g4 h6 9. Qd2 Nbd7 10. O-O-O Bb7 11. h4



- g4: White starts a direct pawn storm and threatens to gain time on the f6 knight.
- h6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Qd2: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- O-O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Opposite-side attacks become tactical when pawns make contact: g5, h5, ...b4, or ...d5 changes lines and tempos immediately.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king? White's resistance is: White opens h- or g-files and uses sacrifices to remove the last pawn shield. The line fails as a template when: Counting squares advanced rather than files opened and tempi gained.

STORE THIS | Pawn storms are decided at contact, not by distance traveled.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Opposite-side attacks become tactical when pawns make contact: g5, h5, ...b4, or ...d5 changes lines and tempos immediately. 2. Identify the first profitable contact, calculate forcing replies, and use defensive pawn moves only when they slow more than they weaken. 3. White opens h- or g-files and uses sacrifices to remove the last pawn shield. 4. Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king? 5. Counting squares advanced rather than files opened and tempi gained.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. g4 h6 9. Qd2 Nbd7 10. O-O-O Bb7

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 091 Decode: The Dragon exchange sacrifice on c3

Prompt: After the exchange sacrifice, name the next two forcing moves and the exact compensation.

Recall: A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.

LESSON 092 Play: The Dragon exchange sacrifice on c3

Prompt: After the exchange sacrifice, name the next two forcing moves and the exact compensation.

Recall: A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.

LESSON 093 Decode: The Najdorf ...d5 clearance

Prompt: What opens after ...d5: which rook, bishop, and queen lines appear for both sides?

Recall: A clearance break is about the pieces released, not the pawn traded.

LESSON 094 Play: The Najdorf ...d5 clearance

Prompt: What opens after ...d5: which rook, bishop, and queen lines appear for both sides?

Recall: A clearance break is about the pieces released, not the pawn traded.

LESSON 095 Decode: Pawn-storm contact points

Prompt: Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king?

Recall: Pawn storms are decided at contact, not by distance traveled.

LESSON 096 Play: Pawn-storm contact points

Prompt: Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king?

Recall: Pawn storms are decided at contact, not by distance traveled.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The Dragon exchange sacrifice on c3

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. Bc4 Bd7 10. O-O-O Rc8 11. Bb3 Ne5 12. h4 Nc4 13. Bxc4 Rxc4

Decision: After the exchange sacrifice, name the next two forcing moves and the exact compensation.

Memory: A thematic sacrifice still needs a forcing continuation and countable compensation.

CARD 2

The Najdorf ...d5 clearance

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. Qd2 b5 8. f3 Nbd7 9. g4 Bb7 10. O-O-O Rc8 11. Kb1 Ne5

Decision: What opens after ...d5: which rook, bishop, and queen lines appear for both sides?

Memory: A clearance break is about the pieces released, not the pawn traded.

CARD 3

Pawn-storm contact points

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. g4 h6 9. Qd2 Nbd7 10. O-O-O Bb7 11. h4

Decision: Which pawn contact is forcing, and does it create a line for a piece already aimed at the king?

Memory: Pawn storms are decided at contact, not by distance traveled.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
091 Decode: The Dragon exchange sacrifice on c3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
092 Play: The Dragon exchange sacrifice on c3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
093 Decode: The Najdorf ...d5 clearance	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
094 Play: The Najdorf ...d5 clearance	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
095 Decode: Pawn-storm contact points	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
096 Play: Pawn-storm contact points	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.